

# THE WATCH: LAW & AUTHORITY NPCs



THE WATCH IS A MONSTER SUPPLEMENT FOR 5E that presents law and authority as a structured, escalating system rather than a handful of interchangeable guards. Instead of relying on a single generic “city guard” stat block, this book provides multiple interconnected ladders of legal power—

from runners, patrols, and wardens to prison officials, magistrates, and realm-level justiciars—each designed to represent a specific role within a functioning justice apparatus.

The intent of this product is consequence-driven play and institutional pressure. Each role supports a distinct style of encounter: arrests, crowd control, pursuit, detention, interrogation, legal escalation, or political fallout. Jurisdictions, legal codes, and loyalties are intentionally undefined, allowing these stat blocks to represent city watches, road wardens, prison authorities, royal courts, or local magistracies in any setting. These NPCs are not obstacles to be fought and forgotten—they are tools of order, leverage, and response. How fair they are, how corrupt they’ve become, and how far their authority reaches is left entirely in the GM’s hands.

## CITY WATCH

{{quote The dragon’s roar shook the ground beneath their feet, and the brave knight stood tall, his sword at the ready. He knew that this would be the battle of his life, but he was determined to emerge victorious.

The City Watch represents visible, everyday law enforcement. These NPCs are the first point of contact between the party and authority: patrols on the street, guards at the gate, officers breaking up brawls, or runners sounding alarms.

The purpose of the City Watch is scene control, not punishment. They establish presence, attempt arrests, manage crowds, and buy time for escalation. Low-ranking watch members are meant to be encountered frequently and resolved quickly, while higher-ranking officers shift encounters away from violence and toward warrants, investigations, or organized response.

At the table, the City Watch exists to:

- Interrupt criminal or disruptive behavior
- Create pressure without immediate lethality
- Signal that the party has been noticed
- Escalate situations without ending them

They are not meant to be boss fights. If the City Watch is fighting to the death, something has already gone wrong.

## ROAD WARDENS

Road Wardens exist where city authority ends. They patrol highways, borders, trade routes, and wilderness

edges, enforcing law across distance rather than density.

Unlike city guards, wardens are independent and experienced by necessity. They are designed to track, follow, and re-engage over time. Their purpose is not to stop crimes in progress, but to ensure that flight does not equal escape.

At the table, wardens are tools of long-term pressure:

- They recognize repeat offenders
- They cut off routes and safe havens
- They turn travel into a risk rather than a reset
- They pursue rather than confront head-on

Wardens are ideal for campaigns where the party believes they can outrun consequences. They exist to prove otherwise.

## CUSTODIAL AUTHORITY

Custodial authority represents what happens after an arrest succeeds. Gaolers, prison guards, warders, and transport officers are not hunters or judges—they are specialists in restraint, detention, and denial of freedom.

These NPCs exist to make capture meaningful. Escaping custody should feel fundamentally different from avoiding arrest, requiring planning, sacrifice, and risk.

At the table, custodial NPCs are used to:

- Run jail scenes and prisoner transport
- Create high-tension escape attempts
- Enforce consequences without execution
- Hold dangerous or political prisoners

Custodial encounters emphasize procedure, coordination, and infrastructure. Bars, locks, chains, and numbers matter more than damage output.

## LEGAL AUTHORITY

Legal Authority NPCs represent the interpretation of law, not its enforcement. Magistrates, justiciars, and judges decide what the law means, who it applies to, and how far it reaches.

These NPCs are not meant to fight often—or well. Their power comes from legitimacy, resources, and the ability to escalate beyond the current scene. Through warrants, courts, magical truth-seeking, and political authority, they shift the campaign itself.

At the table, Legal Authority is used to:

- Turn actions into cases
- Transform crimes into trials or manhunts
- Apply magical and procedural truth pressure
- Change the political landscape of the campaign

Once legal authority enters play, the question is no longer “can the party win this fight,” but “what happens next if they do.”



## THE CITY WATCH

| Name            | Challenge Rating | Description                                                                                                                                                 |
|-----------------|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Watch Runner    | 0                | Messengers and alarm-raisers who summon reinforcements, deliver summons, or report disturbances. They flee immediately once a threat is identified.         |
| Watch Recruit   | 1/8              | Newly sworn watch members with minimal experience. Nervous and procedural, they rely heavily on authority and backup rather than personal skill.            |
| Watch Patrol    | 1/4              | Standard city watch officers assigned to streets, gates, and markets. Trained to question suspects, attempt arrests, and hold ground until support arrives. |
| Watch Sergeant  | 1                | Veteran officers who command patrols and manage escalating incidents. Skilled at coordination, crowd control, and calling reinforcements.                   |
| Watch Captain   | 3                | District commanders responsible for investigations, warrants, and coordinated responses. More administrators than fighters, but dangerous when supported.   |
| Watch Commander | 6                | City-wide authority figures empowered to impose curfews, mobilize the watch, and declare emergencies. Rarely encountered without substantial backup.        |

## ROAD WARDENS

| Name           | Challenge Rating | Description                                                                                                                                           |
|----------------|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Road Warden    | 1/2              | Independent lawkeepers assigned to patrol highways and trade routes. Competent fighters and negotiators who stop travelers and investigate crimes.    |
| Senior Warden  | 2                | Experienced trackers trusted with dangerous routes and difficult cases. Skilled at pursuit, ambush prevention, and coordinating allied patrols.       |
| Border Marshal | 5                | Regional enforcement authorities overseeing borders, passes, and frontier zones. Command wardens across wide territories and lead prolonged manhunts. |

## CUSTODIAL AUTHORITY

| Name              | Challenge Rating | Description                                                                                                                                       |
|-------------------|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Gaoler            | 1/8              | Jail attendants responsible for keys, cells, and basic prisoner handling. Poorly armed but vigilant, relying on locks and procedure for safety.   |
| Prison Guard      | 1/4              | Custodial officers trained to restrain inmates, escort prisoners, and suppress unrest. Prefer control and intimidation over open violence.        |
| Iron Warder       | 1                | Hardened guards assigned to high-risk prisoners and fortified cells. Disciplined, heavily equipped, and trained to hold positions under pressure. |
| Chain Captain     | 2                | Officers in charge of prison blocks, transport details, or chain gangs. Enforce discipline through coordination and deterrence.                   |
| Black Cell Warden | 4                | Elite custodians entrusted with political prisoners and dangerous criminals. Ruthless, methodical, and well-supported.                            |

## LEGAL AUTHORITY

| Name               | Challenge Rating | Description                                                                                                                                                   |
|--------------------|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Court Clerk        | 0                | Record-keepers and scribes who issue summons, maintain ledgers, and document testimony. Dangerous not for violence, but for the legal pressure they initiate. |
| Magistrate's Agent | 1/4              | Investigators and legal enforcers who serve warrants, gather evidence, and escort prisoners. Operate quietly and with broad discretionary authority.          |
| Magistrate         | 1                | Local judicial officials empowered to interpret law, set bail, and order arrests. Rarely fight personally, relying on authority and protection.               |
| Crown Justiciar    | 2                | Regional legal representatives who override local rulings and supervise major cases. Act as the crown's voice in disputes and enforcement.                    |
| High Magistrate    | 4                | Senior judicial authorities controlling courts, prisons, and enforcement within a city or province. Their decisions shape entire regions.                     |
| Lord Justiciar     | 5                | Realm-level legal authority whose rulings trigger sweeping consequences and coordinated enforcement. Not adventurers, but immensely influential.              |



## WATCH RECRUIT

Medium humanoid (any race), any lawful alignment

**Armor Class** 14 (leather armor, shield)

**Hit Points** 9 (2d8)

**Speed** 30 ft.

| STR     | DEX     | CON     | INT     | WIS     | CHA     |
|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|
| 11 (+0) | 12 (+1) | 11 (+0) | 10 (+0) | 11 (+0) | 10 (+0) |

**Skills** Athletics +2, Perception +2

**Senses** passive Perception 12

**Languages** Common

**Challenge** 1/8 (25 XP)

### **Procedural Authority.**

This watch recruit has advantage on Charisma (Intimidation) checks made to issue lawful commands while in uniform or on duty.

**Trained Grappler.** This watch gets +2 bonus for all grapple checks.

### **ACTIONS:**

**Club.** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +2 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 3 (1d4 + 1) bludgeoning damage.

- Ideal for misunderstandings, overreactions, and bad calls.
- Recruits escalate quickly when scared; they call for help early.
- Best used in pairs or with a patrol nearby.





# ROAD WARDENS

## ROAD WARDEN

Medium humanoid (any race), any lawful alignment

**Armor Class** 14 (studded leather)

**Hit Points** 27 (5d8 + 5)

**Speed** 30 ft.

| STR     | DEX     | CON     | INT     | WIS     | CHA     |
|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|
| 13 (+1) | 14 (+2) | 12 (+1) | 11 (+0) | 14 (+2) | 11 (+0) |

**Skills** Athletics +3, Perception +4, Survival +4

**Senses** passive Perception 14

**Languages** Common

**Challenge** 1/2 (100 XP)

### **Lone Authority.**

This road warden has advantage on Wisdom (Insight) checks made to assess travelers and on Wisdom (Survival) checks made to track creatures along roads, trails, or borders.

### **Pursuit Trained.**

This road warden ignores difficult terrain caused by nonmagical undergrowth, rubble, or crowds while dashing.

## ACTIONS:

### **Multiattack.**

This road warden makes two weapon attacks.

**Longsword.** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d8 + 1) slashing damage.

**Light Crossbow.** *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, range 80/320 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d8 + 2) piercing damage.

- Use as lawful friction during travel, not random encounters.
- They question, inspect, and assess before drawing weapons.
- Wardens remember faces and spread descriptions.





## PRISON GUARD

Medium humanoid (any race), any lawful alignment

**Armor Class** 16 (chain shirt, shield)

**Hit Points** 22 (4d8 + 4)

**Speed** 30 ft.

| STR     | DEX     | CON     | INT     | WIS     | CHA     |
|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|
| 13 (+1) | 12 (+1) | 12 (+1) | 10 (+0) | 13 (+1) | 10 (+0) |

**Skills** Athletics +3, Perception +3

**Senses** passive Perception 13

**Languages** Common

**Challenge** 1/4 (50 XP)

### **Containment Training.**

This prison guard has advantage on Strength (Athletics) checks made to grapple or restrain creatures.

### **Detention Discipline.**

While this prison guard is within a prison facility or escorting prisoners, it has advantage on saving throws against being charmed or frightened.

### **ACTIONS:**

**Spear.** *Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft. or range 20/60 ft., one target. *Hit:* 4 (1d6 + 1) piercing damage.

**Shield Bash.** *Strength Saving Throw:* DC 11. On fail take 4 (1d4 + 2) bludgeoning damage and if the target is Medium or smaller it falls Prone.

- Default escort and containment unit.
- Guards prioritize restraint over killing.
- They fight to delay until reinforcements arrive.





## MAGISTRATE

Medium humanoid (any race), any lawful alignment

**Armor Class** 12 (robes)

**Hit Points** 27 (6d8)

**Speed** 30 ft.

| STR     | DEX     | CON     | INT     | WIS     | CHA     |
|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|
| 10 (+0) | 11 (+0) | 10 (+0) | 14 (+2) | 14 (+2) | 13 (+1) |

**Saving Throws** Wis +4

**Skills** Insight +4, Investigation +4, Persuasion +3

**Senses** passive Perception 12

**Languages** Common

**Challenge** 1 (200 XP)

### Judicial Authority.

Creatures subject to this magistrate's jurisdiction have disadvantage on Charisma (Deception) checks made during formal questioning.

### Spellcasting.

This magistrate is a 3rd-level spellcaster. Wisdom is the spellcasting ability (spell save DC 12, +4 to hit with spell attacks). The magistrate has the following spells prepared:

- Cantrips (at will): [guidance](#)
- 1st level: [detect magic](#)
- 2nd level (3 slots): [zone of truth](#)

### ACTIONS:

**Dagger.** *Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack:* +2 to hit, reach 5 ft. or range 20/60 ft., one target. *Hit:* 3 (1d4 + 1) piercing damage.

- Magistrates create scene-based tension: hearings, interrogations, bail decisions.
- Use zone of truth to pressure players, not to auto-resolve mysteries.
- Magistrates should never appear alone unless corruption or desperation is the point.





# COMPATIBLE CONTENT

These lawkeepers fit naturally into any of our [Fantasy Maps](#).

The Road Wardens are especially suited for [Wilderness Encounter Maps](#).

The custodial authority are especially suited for [Fantasy Prison Tower](#).

## LEGAL

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